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camera speed, weight and size, body type, picture modes for morning light, day light, cloudy day, etc.

Megapixels

The resolution in megapixels (MP) tells how much you can enlarge your picture without sacrificing its quality. The choice of megapixels truly depends on what you would like to do with your photos. To be precise, if you intend to take photos only for e-mailing or posting them on Facebook, a 3-5MP camera is sufficient. But if you wish to take large prints of your pictures, you need a higher megapixel count.

The more the pixel count, the sharper the photographs in larger size. A higher megapixel count also gives you the flexibility to crop and print a section of the whole picture.

Today, most digital cameras come with at least 10 MP. There are cameras with even above 12 megapixels. But it is a tad too much. A 5MP resolution

Types of cameras

Compact digital cameras. Pocket- or purse-sized cameras with automated functions meant to ease photography and concentrate wholly on framing the picture. These can display images on a screen immediately after they are recorded, storing thousands of images on a single small memory device, and deleting images to free storage space.

Interchangeable-lens cameras. These cameras eliminate the mirror box and viewfinder optics, and are a combination of low weight, compact size and DSLR-class photographic performance.

DSLR cameras. Digital single-lens reflex (DSLR) cameras use a mechanical mirror system and pentaprism to direct light from the lens to an optical viewfinder on the back of the camera.

—Tadato Kimura, general manager-marketing, Sony India

is enough to take a sharp 20×25cm² (8×10-inch²) print. Likewise, 8 megapixels are enough to take a sharp 28×36cm² (11×14-inch²) print.

Image sensor

The image quality also depends on camera sensors and lenses. Digicams with large sensors and high-quality lenses take crisp shots, regardless of the MP count. So before buying a camera, see how big its sensor is.

Shutter lag and startup time

To capture fine action shots like movement of wild-life subjects, a small

shutter lag is beneficial. Otherwise, by the time the camera's shutter opens, the subject would have disappeared in woods!

Shutter lag is nothing but the delay between triggering the shutter and actually taking the photo. On an average, shutter lag is up to half a second in today's cameras. In high-end point-and-shoot cameras, it could be almost a quarter of a second.

So before buying a camera, check how long it takes to capture its first shot. If it takes a second or less, you have a fast camera. Ask the salesman to help you in finding out how long the camera's autofocus system takes

NIKON

Coolpix S8100

Features

- Dimensions: Approx. 104×59.2×29.9 mm³ (excluding projections)
- Weight: Approx. 184 gm (without batteries and memory card)
- Resolution: 12.1 million pixels
- Optical zoom: 10x
- LCD screen: 7.6cm (3-inch), 921,000-dot, TFT LCD monitor with clear colour display and anti-reflection coating
- HD video recording: Yes
- Others: Nikkor lens with a zoom range beginning at the wide-angle 30mm focal length, advanced technologies for beautiful night shots, high-speed performance of the CMOS image sensor maximised with a high-speed continuous auto overlay function



Price: ₹ 15,950